

an invisible collage

material from invisible cities, italo calvino

the empire's multiform treasures were only illusory envelopes

an opening in the midst of an incongruous landscape

if you saw it, standing in its midst,
it would be a different city

follow zigzag lines from one street to another

everything conceals something else

a forgotten fauna was stirring from its lethargy

taken to copying its underground copy

the rule is to shuffle them each time, then try to assemble them

we have proved that
if we were here, we would not be

this is the foundation of the city:
a net which serves as passage and as support

a barely hinted knot

spiderwebs of intricate relationships seeking a form

made of fragments mixed with the rest

some raise their arms obliquely toward
an aggregation of opaque polyhedrons on the horizon

the empire is being crushed by its own weight

without stones there is no arch

the catalogue of forms is endless

falsehood is never in words; it is in things

the true map of the universe is

fruit so ripe it burst its skin

a stain that spreads out shapelessly

cities that grow in concentric circles

mercury, god of the fickle, to whom the city
is sacred, worked this ambiguous miracle

it acquires the inevitability of phenomena not subject to human caprice

mute informant

ignoring the objects' variety of form, he could grasp
the system of arranging one with respect to the others

he cannot force the operation beyond a certain limit:
he would achieve cities too probable to be real

only the name of the airport changes

the inhabitants repeat the same scenes, with the actors changed

the farewells take place in silence, but with tears

it is our eyelids that separate them, but we cannot
know which is inside and which is outside

like a lake with low shores lost in swamps

the places have mingled

make them endure, give them space